

Talabat Holding (TALABAT.DU): 1Q26 earnings conference call takeaways

Talabat's management hosted its 1Q26 earnings call on May 12. Key takeaways from the call follow.

Guidance retained except increase in net income guidance: Management **retained its full year guidance across key metrics** (11-14% y/y GMV growth, 14-17% y/y Revenue growth, Adjusted EBITDA of US\$ 510-540 million, and Free Cash Flow of US\$ 370-400 million) but **increased Net Income guidance** by US\$ 20mn to US\$ 300-330mn. Management mentioned that the increase in Net Income guidance was due to **reduction in corporate tax**, as it is allowed to adjust some past losses, **lower spending on SBC and lower depreciation** cost due to certain delay in capex. Management mentioned that it **can meet higher end of the guidance** but it depends on the competitive pressure.

Impact of war and Ramadan seasonality: Management mentioned that at the beginning of the conflict it saw an increase in pantry stocking and as a result it went out of stock. However, it quickly replenished stock to build a 3-months inventory by sourcing products from different countries and suppliers, opening up green corridors for shipping products between different countries. Management mentioned that it then saw a decline in demand for delivery as people left the country and tourism declined and extended holidays. Demand then improved during Eid which normally last for 5-7 days and was entirely in 1Q26 (vs. split between 1Q and 2Q last year) which **contributed 2-3%p and led to 18% revenue growth**. Management mentioned that its Eid operations was disrupted due to shutdown of operations due to impact to its data center in Bahrain. Management mentioned that its **international customer declined during the quarter** and it believes they are usually tourists. However, given its high customer base, it does not impact the business.

Competitive pressure: Management mentioned that **competitive pressure eased in 1Q but it has picked up again since April** with discounts increasing from both new entrants and incumbents

Fuel price increase: Management mentioned that fuel price increase has only been in UAE and it contributes less than 10% of its total cost so has not impacted its operations. Management mentioned it has various levers to off-set the impact of higher fuel cost by adjusting delivery fees, repricing subscription fees, order stacking or visiting vendor subscription program.

Adtec revenue: Management mentioned that it increased its adtec revenue marginally despite CPG companies not spending on adtec in a situation where they

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were out of inventory and hence not incentivized to increase their sales.

Regulations against predator pricing: Management mentioned that **Qatar has introduced Code of Conduct** for food delivery companies to avoid predatory pricing and expects **UAE to adopt regulations against predator pricing similar to Dubai in next few weeks**. However, management mentioned that the impact (upside to guidance) depends on enforcement of the regulations.

Delivery Hero management change: Management mentioned that they have very strong relationship with the Board of Delivery Hero and they have approved their plans and despite management change at Delivery Hero, they expect the Board to be supportive of their plans.

Home services offering: Management mentioned that it **does not intend to become a super app** and instead sees more opportunity in food delivery and grocery business where there is low penetration and high growth potential in GCC.

GMV growth (19%yoy): Management mentioned that increase in GMV growth was supported by customer acquisition, favorable Eid seasonality and increase of “eat-at-home” trends during the quarter.

- GCC GMV grew by 12%yoy with all markets growing at double digit and reached 79% of total GMV and Non-GCC GMV grew by 52%yoy and reached 21% of total GMV.
- Management did not disclose Food and G&R growth but mentioned that Food delivery business grew at double digit and Grocery and Retail grew even higher.

Revenue growth (up 22%yoy): Management mentioned that revenue growth was ahead of GMV growth due to higher contribution from T-mart sales which also led to increase in GMV to Revenue take rates to 39%.

Adjusted EBITDA (down 13%yoy/ 4.8%GMV): Management mentioned that it was impacted by (i) \$10mn invested in competitive position to maintain its food delivery leadership which is discretionary and (ii) \$15mn in expanding its T-mart density and T-pro offering which led to higher engagement. Excluding these, underlying EBITDA was up \$12mn.

Net Income: Net Income margin had similar pressure as EBITDA as non operating expense and SBC costs were stable. Management mentioned that SBC is normally lower but increases in 2Q.

Capex plan: With regard to its \$175mn of investment plan, management mentioned that \$55mn of investment for strengthening its food position by investing in best value proposition in best selection and everyday app eco system, and US\$120mn spread between US\$75mn in operating investment and US\$45mn in capex.

Our 12m price target of AED1.69 is derived using a 15.0x growth-adjusted EV/EBITDA multiple (based on the correlation between sales growth and EV/EBITDA multiples for global peers) applied to our 2027 estimates.

Key downside risks to our view and price target include: (1) macroeconomic and geopolitical risks, (2) changes in the competitive landscape, (3) operating risks in expanding verticals, (4) dependence on partner funded discounts, (5) dependency on riders and logistics network, (6) tax changes in the region.

TALABAT.DU	12m Price Target: AED1.69	Price: AED0.90	Upside: 87.8%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: AED21.0bn / \$5.7bn	Revenue (\$ mn)	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Enterprise value: AED19.2bn / \$5.2bn	EBIT (\$ mn)	2,871.6	3,791.0	4,266.5	4,768.4
3m ADTV: NA	EPS (\$)	450.3	562.1	570.2	603.9
United Arab Emirates	EV/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	0.02	0.02	0.02	0.02
MENA Non Financials and South Africa Healthcare	P/E (X)	17.7	8.3	8.0	7.5
M&A Rank: 3	Dividend yield (%)	22.1	12.0	11.8	11.1
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	FCF yield (%)	2.3	7.2	7.3	7.8
	CROCI (%)	4.8	9.2	8.7	9.0
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	134.3	132.6	127.6	120.5
		(0.8)	(1.0)	(1.1)	(1.1)
		6/25	9/25	12/25E	--
	EPS (\$)	0.01	0.01	0.01	-

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 11 May 2026 close.

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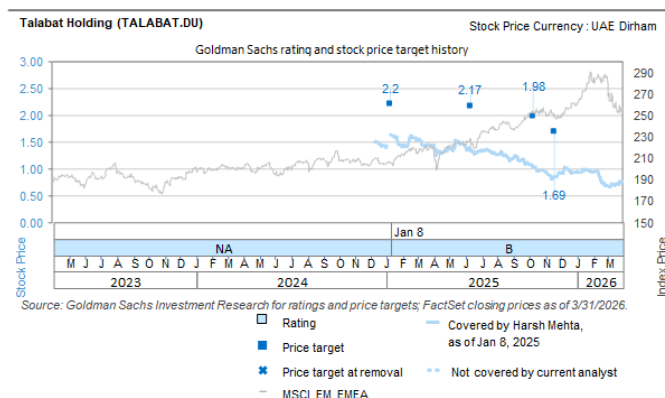
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Talabat Holding (TALABAT.DU)

Date of report	Target price (AED)	Closing price (AED)
19-Nov-25	1.69	0.85
10-Oct-25	1.98	1.04
11-Jun-25	2.17	1.37
09-Jan-25	2.20	1.64

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